Negative Double

Partner opens 1 of a suit and the next opponent overcalls a suit:
Double by you is not for penalty - it says you **would** have responded if no overcall.
You need 6+ points for 1-level double, more for higher level double
Negative Double promises at least four cards in any unbid Major
If both Majors have been bid, double promises both minors
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - dbl - promises 4-card Spade suit
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - 1♠ - promises 5+ card Spade suit

Support Cue-bid

When partner opens and next player overcalls, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

When an opponent opens, partner overcalls, and the next opponent passes, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♣
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣5

Board: 2
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥K

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣5

Board: 4
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠K

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥J

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ 10 9 7 ♥ K 8 7 ♦ A K 6 ♣ K J 10 4	
♠ J 5 4 ♥ Q 6 5 2 ♦ Q 10 8 3 ♣ A 3		♠ Q 8 3 ♥ A J 10 4 ♦ J 5 4 ♣ 7 6 5
	♠ A K 6 2 ♥ 9 3 ♦ 9 7 2 ♣ Q 9 8 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♣	1♥	Dbl
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♣
All Pass			

2♣ by North
Lead: ♣5

SOUTH has four ♠s, so instead of bidding them she makes a Negative Double.

NORTH knows there is no 8-card fit in ♠s, but he does have ♥s stopped. He bids 1NT.

SOUTH has 9 points and with four ♣s she goes back to that suit and NORTH passes.

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 10 5 ♥ Q 5 4 2 ♦ Q 10 8 5 ♣ 8 5 3	
♠ Q 9 7 ♥ J 8 7 ♦ A K 6 ♣ K J 10 4		♠ A K 6 3 2 ♥ 9 3 ♦ 9 7 2 ♣ Q 9 2
	♠ J 8 4 ♥ A K 10 6 ♦ J 4 3 ♣ A 7 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♣	1♥	1♠	Pass
2♠			
All Pass			

2♠ by East
Lead: ♥K

Compare this hand with Deal 6. EAST has five ♠s, this time so she bids 1♠.

WEST knows there IS an 8-card fit in ♠s, so he bids 2♠.

EAST has 10 points so she passes.

Board 3
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 9 7
♥ K 8 7 4
♦ K Q 6
♣ K 10 9 4

♠ Q 10 4 3
♥ J 2
♦ A J 5 4
♣ Q 6 5



♠ K J 8 6
♥ 6 5
♦ 10 8 3 2
♣ 8 7 3

♠ A 5 2
♥ A Q 10 9 3
♦ 9 7
♣ A J 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		Pass	1♥
1♠	2♠	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♣5

NORTH has 11/12 points, a Limit Raise in ♥s. So after the overcall he makes a Support Cue-bid of 2♠.

SOUTH adds her 16 to the 11 that NORTH has promised as a minimum and goes straight to 4♥.

If NORTH had significantly more than 11 he could bid on, but in this case he should happily pass.

Board 4
South Deals
Both Vul

	♠ K Q 10 3 ♥ J 5 ♦ A Q 5 2 ♣ 8 6 5	
♠ 8 5 2 ♥ A Q 10 9 3 ♦ 9 7 ♣ A Q 2		♠ 9 7 ♥ K 8 7 4 ♦ 10 8 6 ♣ K 10 9 4
	♠ A J 6 4 ♥ 6 2 ♦ K J 4 3 ♣ J 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			Pass
1♥	1♠	3♥	
All Pass			

3♥ by West
Lead: ♠K

Compare this with Deal 8.

EAST has 7 points, barely enough for a 2♥ raise if there had been no overcall. But when NORTH puts in the ♠ bid, EAST can jump to 3♥ as a preemptive measure. He knows WEST won't think he has strength because he did not make a Support Cue-bid.

WEST does know it and passes 3♥.

Board 5
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A K 9 7 3 ♥ 6 4 ♦ 6 3 ♣ K J 10 4	
♠ J 10 ♥ Q 8 7 5 ♦ K Q 10 8 ♣ Q 6 3		♠ 5 4 ♥ J 10 2 ♦ A J 5 4 2 ♣ 9 7 5
	♠ Q 8 6 2 ♥ A K 9 3 ♦ 9 7 ♣ A 8 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♦	1♠	Pass	2♦
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♥J

SOUTH has the strength for a raise to game in ♠s, but this could be dangerous since NORTH has overcalled rather than opened. Instead, SOUTH shows her strength with a Support Cue-bid.

NORTH in fact had a pretty good overcall so he jumps to 3♠ and SOUTH bids the game.

With a weak overcall NORTH would have just returned to 2♠ which SOUTH would pass.